

Cassidy K. Buhler, Ph.D.

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PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

- 09/2026 – **Postdoctoral Researcher (Incoming)** Berkeley, CA
Eric and Wendy Schmidt Center for Data Science & Environment (DSE)
University of California, Berkeley
- 09/2024 – **Postdoctoral Fellow** Boulder, CO
08/2026 *Environmental Data Science Innovation & Impact Lab (ESIL)*
University of Colorado, Boulder

EDUCATION

- 2024 **Ph.D. Operations Research** Philadelphia, PA
Computational Data Science Minor
Drexel University
Dissertation: Advances in Optimization with Applications to Biodiversity Conservation
- 2019 **B.S. Mathematics** Salt Lake City, UT
Statistics Emphasis
University of Utah

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- C. K. Buhler**, H. Y. Benson, and D. F. Shanno, “Regularized step directions in nonlinear conjugate gradient methods,” *Mathematical Programming Computation*, vol. 16, pp. 629–664, 2024, ISSN: 1867-2957.  DOI: 10.1007/s12532-024-00265-9.
- C. K. Buhler**, R. S. Terry, K. G. Link, and F. R. Adler, “Do mechanisms matter? Comparing cancer treatment strategies across mathematical models and outcome objectives,” *Mathematical Biosciences and Engineering*, vol. 18, no. 5, pp. 6305–6327, 2021, ISSN: 1551-0018.  DOI: 10.3934/mbe.2021315.

Refereed Conference Proceedings

- C. K. Buhler** and H. Y. Benson, “Decision-making for land conservation: A derivative-free optimization framework with nonlinear inputs,” in *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, vol. 38, 2024, pp. 21932–21939.  DOI: 10.1609/aaai.v38i20.30195.
- C. K. Buhler** and H. Y. Benson, “Optimal land conservation decisions for multiple species,” in *Proceedings of the 52nd Northeast Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference*, vol. 52, Washington, D.C., 2023, pp. 808–816.

Commentary & Perspectives

- C. K. Buhler**, F. Pérez, and C. Boettiger, “Why scientists should lead the shift away from AI mega data centres,” *Nature*, vol. 656, no. 8127, pp. 296–298, 2026.  DOI: 10.1038/d41586-026-02451-2.

Policy & Technical Reports

- J. Howard, C. Schloss, R. Olliff Yang, A. Canales, C. K. Stanley, M. Webb, D. Ackerly, C. Boettiger, **C. Buhler**, S. Monfort, G. Bucciarelli, R. Meyer, A. Levi Simons, J. Bando, L. Chamberlin, S. Veloz, C. Dickison, A. Hill, R. Johnson, R. Hill, A. Kochanek, D. Rademacher, L. Micheli, K. Penrod, G. Rapacciuolo, N. Roth, D. Spatz, D. Gluesenkamp, and collaborators, “California’s 30 x 30 initiative at its midpoint: A biodiversity assessment snapshot of the state’s conservation areas,” *Artemisia*, vol. 51, no. 2, Jan. 2026, California Native Plant Society.  URL: <https://www.cnps.org/artemisia-journal/californias-30-x-30-initiative-at-its-midpoint-44874>.

SOFTWARE

GLEN (Geospatial LLM-Enabled Navigator): A reusable library for map-based applications with LLM-powered data analysis

📄 <https://github.com/boettiger-lab/geo-agent>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.20673849 (2026)

High Seas Explorer

📄 <https://high-seas.nrp-nautilus.io>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.20674176 (2026)

Public GYE Explorer

📄 <https://wyoming-public-demo.nrp-nautilus.io>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.20674178 (2026)

Trust for Public Land Explorer

📄 <https://tpl.nrp-nautilus.io>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.18500622 (2026)

Trust for Public Land California Explorer

📄 <https://tpl-ca.nrp-nautilus.io>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.20674186 (2026)

California 30x30 Planning & Assessment Tool (California Biodiversity Network Edition)

📄 <https://huggingface.co/spaces/boettiger-lab/ca-30x30-cbn>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.16988638 (2025)

LandVote LLM Decision-Support Prototype

📄 <https://huggingface.co/spaces/boettiger-lab/landvote>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.18500795 (2026)

California 30x30 Planning & Assessment Prototype

📄 <https://huggingface.co/spaces/boettiger-lab/ca-30x30>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.14933818 (2025)

Derivative-Free Optimization for Land Conservation

📄 <https://github.com/cassiebuhler/conservation-dfo>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.13742960 (2024)

Conmin-CG: Hybrid Cubic Regularization of Conjugate Gradient Methods

📄 <https://github.com/cassiebuhler/ConminCG>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.13315592 (2024)

DATASETS

State-level 30x30 conservation policy implementation and progress across the United States

📄 <https://source.coop/cassiebuhler/30x30-state-policy>
🔗 10.5281/zenodo.18500907 (2026)

WORKING GROUPS

2026 – **EnviroLLM: Developing Best Practices for Large Language Models in Environmental Science**
Present 🔗 <https://cu-esil.github.io/envirollm/>

2024 – **California Biodiversity Network**
Present 🔗 <https://cabiodiversitynetwork.org/>

WORKING GROUPS (CONTINUED)

2025 **Maka Sitomniya: Preserving Mother Earth by Asserting Lakota Sovereignty in Earth Data Science**
🔗 <https://cu-esiil.github.io/Maka-Sitomniya/>

FELLOWSHIPS & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2024 – **Postdoctoral Fellowship (NSF Award Number: 2153040)** Boulder, CO
2026 *Environmental Data Science Innovation & Impact Lab (ESIIL)*
 University of Colorado, Boulder

2019 – **Doctoral Research Fellow** Philadelphia, PA
2024 *Decision Sciences & MIS Department*
 Drexel University

2019 – **Research Assistant** Salt Lake City, UT
2021 *Adler Lab - Mathematics Department*
 University of Utah

2018 – **Undergraduate Research Assistant** Salt Lake City, UT
2019 *Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU)*
 University of Utah

2018 **Computer Scientist (Internship)** Hill AFB, UT
 309th Software Engineering Group
 United States Air Force

TEACHING

2019 – **Instructor** Philadelphia, PA
2024 *Decision Sciences & MIS Department*
 Drexel University

Course	Level	Quarter(s)	Tool(s)
BSAN 360: Programming for Data Analytics	U	Winter 2022	R
Ph.D. Programming Bootcamp	PhD	Summer 2021; Summer 2022	Python
MIS 200: Management Information Systems (Recitation Section)	U	Fall 2019; Fall 2020; Winter 2021	MS Access; Excel; HTML

*Undergraduate (U)

2019 – **Teaching Assistant** Philadelphia, PA
2024 *Decision Sciences & MIS Department*
 Drexel University

Course	Level	Quarter(s)	Tool
BSAN 360: Programming for Data Analytics	U	Spring 2021	R
BSAN 601: Business Analytics for Managers	MS; MBA	Spring 2024	Excel
MIS 612: Aligning Information Systems & Business Strategies	EMBA; MBA	Fall 2023	-
MIS 625: Management of IT Operations	MBA	Fall 2023	-
OPM 200: Operations Management	U	Spring 2020; Fall 2021; Spring 2023	Excel
OPM 341: Supply Chain Management	U	Spring 2021; Spring 2022; Fall 2022	Excel
OPM 344: Revenue Management	U	Fall 2022	Excel
OPR 320: Linear Models for Decision Making	U	Summer 2020; Spring 2021	Excel

TEACHING (CONTINUED)

Teaching Assistant (Continued)

Course	Level	Quarter(s)	Tool
STAT 201: Intro to Business Statistics	U	Winter 2020; Spring 2020; Fall 2021; Summer 2022; Spring 2023; Winter 2024	Excel
STAT 202: Business Statistics II	U	Summer 2021; Spring 2023	Excel
STAT 205: Statistical Inference I	U	Spring 2020; Fall 2021	Excel
STAT 206: Statistical Inference II	U	Summer 2021	Excel
STAT 510: Intro to Statistics for Business Analytics	MBA	Summer 2023; Winter 2024	Excel
STAT 642: Data Mining for Business Analytics	MS; PhD	Winter 2023	R

*Undergraduate (U)

2018 – **Mathematics & Computer Lab Assistant** Salt Lake City, UT
 2019 *T. Benny Rushing Mathematics Student Center*
University of Utah

PRESENTATIONS

2026 **ESA Annual Meeting 2026** Salt Lake City, UT
 Talk: Collaborative conservation planning with AI decision-support tools

2026 **Mountain Research Station (MRS) Summer Seminar Series** Nederland, CO
 Talk: Responsibly using AI for conservation decision-making

2026 **Natural Capital Symposium 2026** Stanford, CA
 Talk: Codeveloping AI decision-support tools to democratize conservation planning

2025 **California 30x30 Partnership 2025 Summit** San Diego, CA
 Talk: Metrics with Meaning: Assessing, Tracking, and Supporting 30x30 Biodiversity Conservation

2025 **NASA Biodiversity and Ecological Conservation Team Meeting** Washington, DC.
 Poster: Leveraging NASA Data to Guide Biodiversity Conservation Investments with the Trust for Public Land

2024 **AGU Annual Meeting (AGU24)** Washington, DC.
 Poster: Exploring innovation in biodiversity conservation decision-making through open science and generative AI

2024 **AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI-24)** Vancouver, BC, Canada.
 Poster: Decision-making for land conservation: A derivative-free optimization framework with nonlinear inputs

2023 **MIT Sloan Rising Scholars Conference** Cambridge, MA (Virtual)
 Talk: Decision-making for land conservation: A derivative-free optimization framework with nonlinear inputs

2023 **INFORMS Annual Meeting** Phoenix, AZ.
 Talk: Decision-making for land conservation: A derivative-free optimization framework with nonlinear inputs

2023 **SIAM Conference on Optimization (OP23)** Seattle, WA.
 Talk: Reserve design in biodiversity conservation

PRESENTATIONS (CONTINUED)

2023	NEDSI Annual Conference Talk: Optimal land conservation decisions for multiple species	Washington, D.C.
2021	INFORMS Annual Meeting Talk: Regularized step directions in conjugate gradient minimization for machine learning	Anaheim, CA. (Virtual)
2021	SIAM Conference on Optimization (OP21) Talk: Conjugate gradient methods for machine learning	Virtual.
2020	INFORMS Annual Meeting Talk: Efficient solution of portfolio optimization problems via dimension reduction and sparsification	Virtual.

MEDIA

2026	The Mountain-Ear Podcast Interview: Inside CU's world-class alpine research center  podcasts.apple.com	Nederland, CO
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AWARDS & GRANTS

2023	Rising Scholar MIT Sloan School of Management
2023	Graduate Student Travel Subsidy Award Drexel University
2023	DEI & Environment and Sustainability Innovation Micro-Grant Drexel University
2023	Teck-Kah Lim Graduate Student Travel Subsidy Award Drexel University
2023	Student Travel Award Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics (SIAM)
2022	Teaching Assistant Excellence Award Drexel University
2021	Teaching Assistant Excellence Award (Highly Commended) Drexel University
2021	Student Travel Award Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics (SIAM)
2019	Undergraduate Research Scholar Designation University of Utah

SERVICE

2025	Panelist Event: Femme in STEM	CU Boulder, Career Services
2024-Present	CIRES Science Pathways Speaker • Promoting science engagement by delivering flash talks at Colorado institutions	Cooperative Institute for Research in Environmental Science

SERVICE (CONTINUED)

2023	Session Chair Session: Nonlinear Optimization in Machine Learning	<i>INFORMS Annual Meeting</i>
2023	Session Organizer Session: Nonlinear Optimization and Applications	<i>SIAM Conference on Optimization</i>
2023	Session Chair Session: Land, Sand, and Plastic Management	<i>NEDSI Annual Conference</i>
2022	Panelist Event: Graduate Teaching Assistance Orientation	<i>Drexel University</i>
2019	Mathematics Tutor (Volunteer) • Provided weekly tutoring sessions at the Utah State Prison • Supported students who are incarcerated and taking a Salt Lake Community College math course	<i>Utah Prison Education Project</i>